

Rayven Perkins of North Virginia, has also been an avid couponer, off and on, since 2003. In her early thirties, Perkins is married to a man who literally and figuratively supports her desire to stay at home with their children. Rayven's website, www.stay-a-stay-at-home-mom.com, covers ways that mothers at home can make and save money, including couponing and bartering. Their family income of approximately \$70,000 a year for a family of four allows her to indulge in some interesting hobbies, one of which is couponing. Perkin's interest in couponing mostly extends to the savings she finds on toiletries and health and beauty items, along with the deals she can find on healthy food for her family.

Years after the deal, Perkins still raves over a particularly exciting coup that she pulled off, repeating the same deal scenario over sixty times at Target, and filling a freezer full of meat while netting enough excess bags of charcoal that she was able to barter for a night at a whirlpool suite at a historic mansion bed and breakfast. She also bartered charcoal for a camping lamp, fishing poles and reels, and bicycles for the family. Her repetitive trips went something like this: add an 18-pound bag of charcoal to the cart, one jar of KC masterpiece Sauce, a Hormel pork roast, two pounds of ground beef, and three dollars in fresh produce. By strategically combining coupons good on Kingsford, free sauce when you buy charcoal, \$6 off pork when you buy both charcoal and sauce, \$4 off beef when you buy Kingsford, and a "\$3 off" produce coupon when you buy Hormel roast, Rayven was able to walk out of the store having paid just \$6.47 for \$25.96 worth of food. Repeating that sixty times, she netted over fifteen hundred dollars worth of food and charcoal for less than four hundred dollars.